

THE COLD CITY

GAME RULES & MOVES • DISTRICT 01

A turn-based tactical combat slice: one hooded pilgrim crosses a single city district and must defeat every enemy to survive.

1 • OBJECTIVE

- **Win:** defeat all three enemies (Goon, Mortar, and Sniper).
- **Lose:** the Pilgrim's health reaches 0.

2 • THE BOARD

- A grid **12 tiles wide × 6 tiles tall** (landscape).
- Movement is **orthogonal only** — up, down, left, right. No diagonal steps.
- **Attack range** is measured in king-moves: a range of 1 reaches all **8 surrounding tiles**, so a diagonally-adjacent foe can be struck.
- Only **one unit may occupy a tile** at a time. Walls are solid and block movement.

3 • TURN STRUCTURE

Play alternates between the Pilgrim's turn and the enemies' turn.

- **Pilgrim's turn** — take up to **one step and one strike, in either order** (or just one, or neither). The turn **ends automatically** once both actions are used or none remain; the **End Turn** control skips a leftover action.
- **Enemies' turn** — every living enemy acts once, resolved in order: **Sniper, then Mortar, then Goon**.

4 • THE PILGRIM (YOU)

Attribute	Value
Health	10 (maximum 10)
Strike damage	2
Strike range	1 — any adjacent tile, including diagonals
Movement	1 tile per turn (orthogonal)
Starting position	column 1, row 3

Your moves each turn:

- **Step** — move one orthogonal tile to an empty, in-bounds, non-wall tile.
- **Strike** — deal 2 damage to one enemy within range.
- **End turn** — pass, skipping any unused step or strike.

5 • THE ENEMIES (each has 3 health)

Goon — the chaser | 3 HP, 1 damage, moves 1 tile

- Each turn it takes the **closest path toward the Pilgrim**, routing around walls.
- If orthogonally adjacent to the Pilgrim, it **strikes for 1** instead of moving.

Mortar — the artillery | 3 HP, 3 damage, stationary

- Every turn it shells **the tile where the Pilgrim last stood** (your position at the start of the turn). A **reticle** marks that tile in advance.
- **Counter-play:** if you **step** during your turn you leave that tile, so the shell craters empty ground — and you may still strike the same turn. Standing still (striking without stepping, or being stunned) lets the shell find you.

Sniper — the marksman | 3 HP, 2 damage, moves 1 tile

- Every turn it **steps away** from the Pilgrim, trying to keep its distance (it kites).
- It **fires for 2** whenever the Pilgrim is **outside its 5×5 watch** (more than 2 tiles away in any direction) **and** it has a clear line of sight.
- **Counter-play**: close inside the 5×5 to stop its fire, break its line of sight behind cover, or herd it into a wall or board corner where it cannot retreat.

6 · TERRAIN & HAZARDS

- **Walls / Cover** — solid concrete. **Impassable** for every unit, and they **block the Sniper's line of fire**.
- **Trap** — a **3×3 field**. The first time the Pilgrim **steps into** it, the Pilgrim is **stunned**: next turn they **cannot step** (they may still strike or end the turn). It **decays over about 8 rounds**, then disappears.
- **Shrines** — end a step on one to **roll a six-sided die** for a power (below). Each shrine is **consumed** after one use.

7 · POWERUPS (roll 1d6 at a shrine)

Roll	Power	Effect
1	Whisper	Nothing happens.
2	Mend	+2 maximum health and heal to full.
3	Reach	Strike range becomes 2 (hit foes two tiles away).
4	Edge	+1 strike damage (permanent).
5	Ward	Block the next incoming hit entirely (stacks).
6	Bloom	Your next strike hits all foes in range at once (one use).

8 · CONTROLS

- **Click a tile** to step there | **click a foe** in range to strike it.
- WASD / Arrows step | Space / Enter end turn | R restart.

9 · DEFAULT SCENARIO (starting layout)

Coordinates are (column, row); columns 0–11 left→right, rows 0–5 top→bottom.

Piece	Position(s)
Pilgrim	(1, 3)
Goon	(7, 3)
Mortar	(10, 1)
Sniper	(11, 4)
Walls (cover)	(5, 1) (5, 2) (6, 2) (6, 4) (8, 1) (8, 4) (9, 2)
Trap (3×3, centered)	(4, 3)
Shrines	(2, 1) and (3, 5)

Design summary. All three enemies punish standing still or staying in the open, while the Pilgrim moves and strikes only once per turn. You survive by **using cover** against the Sniper, **staying mobile** against the Mortar, and **choosing when to trade blows** with the Goon — earning the occasional shrine power to tip the odds.